The Northwind Health file

Mosaic Practitioner capstone · Teaching case: Northwind Health is fictional.

The Northwind file

This is a teaching case. Some Mosaic features appear in it earlier than they were released. All names and figures are invented for teaching.

The next six screens are the Northwind file: Exhibits A to E. Take your time with them. Strong candidates spend about an hour here before writing anything.

Northwind Health

- A regional health system: one 180-bed community hospital and 6 outpatient clinics, with 640 employees.
- Merged with Lakeside Clinic Group (4 of the 6 clinics) 18 months before the engagement.
- Strategy, "One Northwind": common standards, shared scheduling, cross-site care teams.
- Presenting concerns: nursing turnover of 24% (up from 16%). Clinic staff "feel like a different company". Leaders say strategy is clear, while frontline staff say it isn't.
- Executive team: Dana Okafor (CEO), Jordan Reyes (COO, leads the integration), Sam Whitfield (CNO), Priya Natarajan (CFO), Alex Moreau (Chief People Officer, your client sponsor) and Taylor Brooks (VP, Clinic Operations, formerly CEO of Lakeside Clinic Group). Everyone uses they/them.

Engagement timeline

When	What	Tool
Jan 2026	Scoping; order placed	None
Feb 9 to Mar 6, 2026	Census of all 640 employees	Culture Mosaic (Exhibit A)
Mar 2026	Report generated after close; executive readout	Culture Mosaic report
Mar 16 to Apr 10, 2026	"Change Readiness" for nursing and clinic staff	Mosaic Signal (Exhibit B)
Apr to May 2026	360s for all 6 executives	Leadership Mosaic 360 (Exhibit C shows Jordan's)
Jun 2026	Team report for the 6 executives	LM Team Report (Exhibit D)
Apr to Sep 2026	Action plan on the 3 lowest tiles (Collaboration, Change Ready, Empowered Teams): cross-site huddles, a joint nursing council, a decision-rights charter	None
Oct 5 to Oct 23, 2026	Progress check on those 3 domains	Culture Progress Monitor (Exhibit E)
Nov 18, 2026	Board briefing	Your capstone
2027 (proposed)	Possible Culture Dig	Culture Dig

Exhibit A: Culture Mosaic (Feb–Mar 2026), part 1

A1. Research methodology

Invited	640
Responded	412
Response rate	64% (64.4)
Sampling	Census
Respondent tier	251–500 responses. The 80% warning (400 responses) arrived on day 17; no upgrade was needed.
Breakdowns bought	One: by department (A6)

A2. Headline diamond: tile scores (0–100)

Dimension	Tile	Tile score	Dimension score
Adapt	Change Ready	48	59
	Future Focused	55	
	Customer	74	
Inspire	Purpose	82	66
	Strategy	51	
	Values	66	
Deliver	Efficiency	57	58
	Decisions	73	
	Collaboration	44	
Enable	Empowered Teams	49	54
	Capability Development	53	
	Learning	61	

Tile sizes: 84–100, none. 68–83, Purpose, Customer, Decisions. 52–67, Values, Learning, Efficiency, Future Focused, Capability Development. 36–51, Strategy, Empowered Teams, Change Ready, Collaboration.

"Where to start" (the 3 lowest tiles): Collaboration 44, Change Ready 48, Empowered Teams 49.

A3. Selected item rows (1–5 scale; Typical = the median of benchmark organizations' means)

Tile	Item	Your score	Typical	Percentile	N
Purpose	"Our purpose is well understood and clearly describes why we exist."	4.4	3.9	88	410
Collaboration	"Disagreements are rarely openly explored and managed to keep momentum." (Reverse-scored. Shown after reversal, so higher is better.)	2.6	3.3	14	405
Empowered Teams	"Speaking up is done regularly by people at all levels, even on difficult topics."	2.9	3.4	21	408
Learning	"Mistakes are viewed as learning opportunities."	3.3	3.5	38	407
Learning	"Diverse perspectives are sought out and listened to."	3.2	3.4	33	409
Change Ready (leader-only)	"When it comes to our response to changes outside of our control, we are informed and prepared to pivot."	3.9	3.6	71	58
Future Focused (leader-only)	"Strategic options and opportunities are regularly explored by scanning the external environment."	3.4	3.5	44	58

Tile	Item	Your score	Typical	Percentile	N
Decisions	"We weigh evidence and different viewpoints before committing to a decision."	4.2	3.4	91	409
Decisions	"We know when a decision should be made collaboratively and when it should not."	3.1	3.1	49	406

Everyone saw the leader-only items, but only respondents tagged as leaders are scored on them, so their N is 58.

A4. Psychological Safety Index

The mean of four items, per respondent: the Collaboration item (reversed), speaking up, mistakes as learning, and diverse perspectives. Northwind's index is 2.96, which rounds to 3, so the deck shows the level 3 slide: "The level of psychological safety in your organization is acceptable to attempt to create change in your organization but presents a risk to success. You may want to first focus on improving psychological safety prior to focusing on other change efforts." The deck doesn't print 2.96. It's given here for the case.

Exhibit A: Culture Mosaic (Feb–Mar 2026), part 2

A5. Leaders vs non-leaders (0–100). The leader question is "Level"; Manager, Director, VP and Executive count as leaders.

Tile	Leaders (n=58)	Non-leaders (n=354)	Gap
Strategy	72	47	25
Empowered Teams	70	45	25
Purpose	86	81	5
Collaboration	55	42	13

A6. Comparison heatmap by department (0–100; minimum group size 3)

Tile	Nursing (n=161)	Clinic Network (n=97)	Support Services (n=88)	Admin & Corporate (n=46)	Other (n=20)	Overall (n=412)
Change Ready	45	39	52	63	50	48
Purpose	84	77	80	88	82	82
Strategy	46	44	52	74	53	51
Collaboration	38	36	49	61	50	44
Customer	79	72	66	74	70	74
Empowered Teams	44	46	52	66	51	49

Footnote: "Other" includes Pharmacy (n=2), which is below the minimum group size and so rolls up into Other.

A7. Free-response themes (AI summaries)

"What aspects of our culture… will continue to serve us well?" 318 of 412 responded.

- Headline: "People are proud of the care they give and the teams they work in day to day."
- Commitment to patients (Many)
- Strong teamwork within units (Several)
- Flexible scheduling in clinics (A few)

"…biggest areas of opportunity to improve?" 301 of 412 responded.

- Headline: "Since the merger, sites feel disconnected and frontline voices feel unheard."
- Cross-site coordination after the merger (Many)
- Staffing and workload (Many)
- Decisions made without frontline input (Several)
- Unclear "One Northwind" priorities (A few)

A8. Benchmark status

- The report was generated after the survey closed.
- The buyer consented to the research database at checkout (a US organization: the box was pre-ticked and left ticked).
- 412 responses is above the 10-respondent minimum.
- So Northwind joined the Culture Mosaic benchmark. The pool had more than 5 organizations, so percentiles and typical markers show.

Exhibit B: Mosaic Signal, Change Readiness (Mar–Apr 2026)

- **Audience:** nursing and clinic staff, through a link shared at huddles and by QR code.
- **Purchase:** the 101–250 band (1–100 was considered). Template: Change Readiness Assessment.
- **Stories collected:** 142.
- **Prompt** (edited from the template): "Tell us about a time in the last few months when a change at Northwind affected your work. What happened?"
- There is no scored report and no benchmark.

Question	What the charts show
Triad: Willing / Able / Ready	Density is concentrated along the Willing edge, about 40% from Able. Very few stories sit near Able. Average marker: Willing 0.52, Able 0.18, Ready 0.30.
Dyad: Waited to see ↔ Jumped in early	One hump, around 62 (leaning toward "jumped in early").
Dyad: Official announcements ↔ Word of mouth	Two humps. 38% of answers are within 15 points of "Official announcements" and 41% within 15 points of "Word of mouth". Mean = 52.
Stones (across: Absent to Fully Present; up: Ineffective to Highly Effective)	**Vision:** present, moderately effective. **Resources:** mostly absent, ineffective. **Skills:** present, effective. **Support:** split. Clinic stories place it absent and ineffective; hospital stories place it present.

Sample stories behind the "Willing, not Able" cluster (paraphrased):

- "We were told to use the shared scheduling system on Monday. Nobody had logins until Thursday."
- "I want the cross-site float pool to work, but I've never been trained on the other clinic's charting."

Exhibit C: Leadership Mosaic 360, Jordan Reyes, COO (Apr–May 2026)

Confidential to Jordan Reyes. Shared with you as their practitioner. Not for the board briefing: don't show or describe these results to the board. You may use what they taught you to shape your recommendations.

C1. Rater mix

Category	Invited	Completed	Shown in the report?
Self	1	1	Yes
Boss (Dana Okafor, CEO)	1	1	Yes. Named as "Boss 1 (Dana Okafor)"
Peers	5	4	Yes (3 or more)
Direct Reports	8	7	Yes (3 or more)
Other (a board liaison and an external partner)	2	2	No. Fewer than 3, so the category is folded. The folded pool (2) is also under 3, so these 2 are left out of All Others and their comments are withheld.

All Others = Boss + Peers + Direct Reports = 12 raters.

C2. Dimension and selected tile means (1–7 scale)

	Self	All Others	Boss 1	Peers	Direct Reports	Gap (Self minus All Others)
ADAPT	5.9	4.6	5.0	4.2	4.7	+1.3
Change Ready	6.2	4.4	5.1	4.0	4.5	+1.8
INSPIRE	5.5	5.6	6.0	5.4	5.6	−0.1
DELIVER	6.1	5.9	6.2	5.8	5.9	+0.2
Decisions	5.0	6.0	6.3	5.9	6.0	−1.0
ENABLE	5.2	4.3	5.4	4.8	3.8	+0.9
Empowered Teams	5.6	4.1	5.5	4.8	3.6	+1.5

On the 0–100 scale, (mean − 1) ÷ 6 × 100: All Others ADAPT 4.6 is 60; Self ADAPT 5.9 is 82.

C3. Selected items (1–5 scale; the percentile is for All Others)

Item	Self	Boss 1	Peers	Direct Reports	All Others percentile
Q2 "…involve my team in change efforts to maximize their involvement and commitment."	6	5	3.8	3.9	19
Q4 "…deliberate in communicating changes… including the 'why'…"	6	5	4.0	4.1	24
Q34 "…encourage and expect the use of data in decision-making…"	5	6	6.0	6.3	82
Q45 "…create space for others to contribute."	6	5	4.5	3.4	12

The leader pool had 30 or more leaders, so percentiles show.

C4. AI summaries of direct reports' comments

- **Strengths (Positive):** "Direct reports describe a sharp, data-driven operator who makes timely calls and protects the team from noise."
- **Improve (Mixed):** "Several want more say before changes land; integration decisions feel finished before they hear about them."
- **Blind spot (Mixed):** "May not see how quickly urgency shuts down debate in meetings."

Exhibit D: LM Team Report, executive team (Jun 2026)

- 6 leaders. 5 completed a self-assessment, so Self is shown (3 or more).
- Leaders are unlabeled everywhere in this report.

Rater pools across the team

Category	Raters	Shown?
Bosses	9 (the board chair rated the CEO; the CEO rated 5 executives; plus 3 others)	Yes, pooled and anonymous
Peers	22	Yes
Direct Reports	38	Yes
Others	5	Yes (3 or more, pooled)

Team Score by dimension (all raters except Self; the equal-weight mean of the leaders' means; 1–7 scale)

Dimension	Team Score	Team Self	Range across leaders
Adapt	4.8	5.6	4.3–5.4
Inspire	5.7	5.8	5.2–6.1
Deliver	5.8	5.9	5.3–6.2
Enable	4.5	5.4	3.8–5.6

"Where Each Leader Stands", Empowered Teams: the six unlabeled dots are widely scattered, from 3.6 to 5.7.

Team percentile cells are the average of the 6 individual percentiles. They are not the percentile of the team average.

Exhibit E: Culture Progress Monitor (Oct 2026)

- **Baseline:** the February 2026 Culture Mosaic (412 responses).
- **Domains re-measured:** Collaboration, Change Ready, Empowered Teams.
- **Invited:** 610 (headcount changed). **Responded:** 287. **Response rate:** 47%.
- **Minimum group size:** 3.

E1. Progress summary (0–100)

Domain	Baseline (Feb 2026, n=412)	Now (Oct 2026, n=287)	Change	Label
Collaboration	44	52	+8	Meaningful improvement (p < .001)
Change Ready	48	51	+3	No meaningful change (p = .19)
Empowered Teams	49	47	−2	No meaningful change (p = .41)

E2. Progress by department: Collaboration (0–100)

Group	Baseline	Now	Change
Nursing	38 (n=161)	41 (n=104)	+3
Clinic Network	36 (n=97)	49 (n=64)	+13
Support Services	49 (n=88)	55 (n=71)	+6
Admin & Corporate	61 (n=46)	62 (n=40)	+1
Other	50 (n=20)	53 (n=8)	+3

"Other" is shown because it meets the minimum group size of 3 in both waves.

E3. How the comments shifted ("biggest areas of opportunity")

- Direction: more positive.
- "Cross-site coordination after the merger": FADED
- "Staffing and workload": STEADY
- "Decisions made without frontline input": STEADY
- "New cross-site huddles are helping": NEW

Then and Now quotes are shown at whole-organization level, where each wave has 5 or more answers.